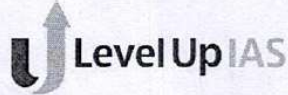


Q.6c (15 marks): Consumption is always social even when it addresses physical needs



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

6.c) Consumption is always social even when it addresses physical needs. Elaborate (15 marks)

The Karakati Text of Boas refers to conspicuous consumption by them during Potlachs as a means of demonstrating power, superiority and self esteem.

Hence consumption can be social even when it addresses physical needs because redistribution maybe deemed to be "necessity" but the aspect of social glorification cannot be wished away.

Where consumption is social & physical

① Conspicuous consumption → Greater showcase of power through ostentatiousness & donning exclusive finery

② Large Big Fat Indian Wedding in South India even at cost of significant credit disability → showmanship

② Non productive destruction of wealth - Potlach

Competitive potlach involves outdoing each other during the process of material destruction

③ Large scale bets placed on Sambagan

Clifford Geertz symbolism in Tana

bets placed higher when people of similarly situated social positions are vying against each other -

④ African tribe a man's wealth is gauged by the girth of his belly indicative of prosperity.

Nonetheless not all consumption has social connotations

① Tribal subsistence living :- (c)

The Korwa tribe does not have social implications to feasting

Consumption by bands (eg) Eskimos
do not concern social bonds

in winter $\rightarrow$ less resource store

in summer $\rightarrow$ greater resource $\rightarrow$ wastage of food

Here food is treated only as a physical entity to satisfy needs.

In Mahlow's Theory of Needs
he refers to hunger as a secondary need
that needs satisfaction

While there exists some punishments

(eg) Chenchu, where social control also dictates throwing feast to mendries, largely, the tribal situation since its tied to social context generally has connotations extending beyond just physical satisfaction